

**Ephraim Joshua M. Flores**

BSCPE-3

CPE 3302 – Seminars and Field Trips, Group 3

Activity: A Journey to Building Cebu's Future

Speaker: Vice Gov. Glenn Anthony Soco

Venue: Michael Richartz Center, USC-TC | Date: July 9, 2026

**Summary of the Activity**

In the seminar "A Journey to Building Cebu's Future" held at the Michael Richartz Center, USC-TC on July 9, 2026, Vice Gov. Glenn Anthony Soco talked about how discipline, humility, and the choice to build where you are lead to real success. He said his values came from his parents, his father a bank employee and his mother the founder of a small business she started in 1972, and that they measured success by how hard a person works, not by what they know. He recalled how his father enrolled him in the bank's Happy Savers Club and how he would walk three to five kilometers home from school just to save part of his daily allowance, a habit he now sees as the root of his discipline. He also talked about how sports, particularly volleyball, shaped his character, from getting cut from the team in his first year of high school to becoming a varsity player at USC on full scholarship, and how he turned down a shot at the Philippine national team because he chose his family and Cebu over moving away. According to Soco, "success is not about moving home, sometimes success is about choosing to build where you are." He also said that "successful people are built by small decisions, repeated every day," and that in sports, "you cannot fake preparation, you cannot negotiate with the ball." He then shared how he shifted from mechanical to industrial engineering to carve his own path apart from his family of accountants, and how at 21, fresh out of college, he chose to join his mother's struggling company instead of working abroad, learning the business from scratch right before the 1997 Asian financial crisis hit. In the end, Soco's talk boils down to one point: real success is built slowly, through discipline, humility, and the willingness to stay and work hard where you already are.

**Insights and Acquired Knowledge**

What stuck with me most is the point about small decisions building success, not big moments. It matches what I've been dealing with in my thesis work, where progress is really just one module, one working feature at a time. Soco choosing to stay in Cebu and rebuild his mother's business instead of taking an easier path abroad also hit me, since it is a reminder that growth does not always mean leaving what you already have. I also related to the part about sports building discipline, since that same idea of earning every point without shortcuts applies directly to debugging and building systems that actually work. Overall the talk reinforced that consistency and staying grounded matter more than talent or opportunity alone.